



Pocket brain

The first electronic computers filled a large room. Now there are smarter and faster computers that can be held in your hand, such as this smartphone.



Bytes and megabytes

Computers can help with homework, or steer a rocket into space.



Laptop computer



Tablet computer



Global positioning system (GPS)



Gaming device

Shrinking switches

The switches in computers have gotten steadily smaller, and more complicated.

The first computers had glass valve switches as big as your thumb.



Computers now have microprocessors. They are only the size of a small fingernail, yet packed with billions of switches.



Data center